

Monsters of the deep



Ichthyosaurus

There may have been no marine dinosaurs, but a frightening variety of toothed giant reptiles ruled the seas while the dinosaurs ruled the land.



Ichthyosaurs had large eyes.

Swim away...

An *Ichthyosaurus* moves swiftly to avoid being eaten. The swimming ichthyosaurs, including *Ichthyosaurus* itself, were perfectly suited for chasing fast-moving prey, such as squid. However, they were vulnerable to attack from larger marine reptiles.

...from danger!

Watch out!

A *Liopleurodon* is attacking the ichthyosaurs from behind. Perhaps the largest sea-based predator of all time, *Liopleurodon* was a short-necked plesiosaur.

Elasmosaurus

Elasmosaurus was air-breathing, just like whales today.

Its neck was as long as its body.

